



**DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2021-2022
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION**

**CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET A)**

**FULL MARKS: 50
TIME: 1 HOUR 30 MINUTES**

General Instructions:

- This paper consists of four printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.

Question 1:

Write a composition (150-200 words) on any one of the following:

[10]

- a) Looking back at the last ten years of your life, describe the events that have been significant in shaping your personality.
- b) 'It is better to be born talented than to be born rich'. Give your views either for or against this statement.
- c) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- a) Covid has transformed the world of a student overnight. Write a letter to your grandfather sharing your new experience of 'online classes', how the digital medium has saved your education from coming to a standstill and how you have grown as a student in this time of distress.
- b) The main road leading to your locality has three open manholes (holes on the road surface with lids) causing frequent accidents at night, especially during the rainy season. Write a letter to the Editor of a newspaper drawing attention to this problem of the residents and seeking help to improve the condition of the roads in your locality.

Question 3

Your school is organising an Inter-House Recitation Competition. Draft a notice for your school notice board giving relevant details of the event and inviting students from classes VIII to X to register their names.

[5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

Gift the Habit of Reading

Right from childhood, a human being starts enjoying the pleasure of reading. As a child, he learns the ways of life through reading and writing. He is thrilled by going through new little things and learning through them. Any new lesson that comes his way excites his emotions by giving his little mind the freshness of knowledge. The pleasure one derives from reading is indeed recreational as well as instructive. Reading sharpens your thought processes. It increases your attention span. It gives you the abilities of thinking and understanding. Reading a book aloud can be a good exercise not just for memorization but also for improvement of speech and vocabulary. Books trigger your power of imagination, too.

Reading of novels or other interesting literature makes a person forget the worries and cares of life. Reading of a newspaper, periodical, journal etc., which is light reading, gives the reader knowledge about human life around and solves his curiosity about the world. Newspaper and journals give information about the events taking place in the world and happenings in the state and the locality a person lives in. The newspapers also publish important news and views in the fields of economics, politics and science. Reading the newspaper is necessary for even a little educated citizen in modern society. Reading of novels is the most popular pastime of a large number of people. The attraction of a novel lies in its ability to create interest, to maintain it and take the reader to the heights of imagination and fiction. All fictions are somewhat connected with life and they give in words the picture drawn from real life or from imagination. As such, of all forms of literature, novels are the most popular and interesting. They portray pictures from our real life and society and present the character of the people we see around or wish to see. A novel inspires the interest and intention of the reader because in it, scenes rapidly shift and change and there are unexpected turns of events giving shocks and shakes to the mind.

Next, we come to the books of travel and adventure. The spirit of adventure is in the very blood of man. A man wants glamour and romantic life, full of adventure and material spirit. Books of travel and adventure introduce a spirit of fearlessness in which the travellers, who are the heroes of the books, inspire in us. Among the books of adventure lies the best literature in the world. Whatever the type of books one reads, the reading is always a source of pleasure and enjoyment, the habit of reading is a sign of good culture. It is a source of knowledge and the best means of making use of one's leisure. Books are, after all, a goldmine of knowledge, art, literature and science. Books are not only useful and instructive but also entertaining and fun!

a) Give the meanings of the following words as used in the passage. One word answers or short phrases will be accepted. [2]

- i) Trigger-
- ii) Glamour-

b) Answer the following questions briefly:

- i) Give three benefits of reading. [3]
- ii) How can reading a newspaper widen our knowledge? [2]
- iii) 'Among the books of adventure lies the best literature in the world'- Why does the narrator say the above line? [2]
- iv) Which phrase from the passage proves that the author wants to encourage you to gift a book? [1]

c) In not more than 50 words, write why novels are the most popular and interesting form of literature. [5]

Question 5 [4]

Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets
Do not copy the passage but write the numbers and answer with the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space.

Example: Answer (0)- was waiting

A woman ____0____ (wait) at an airport one night for several hours. She hunted for a book in the airport shops, ____1____ (buy) a box of cookies and found a place to sit. While she ____2____ (engross) in her book, she realised that a man sitting beside her, grabbed a cookie or two from the box in between. To avoid a scene, she was quiet and kept on ____3____ (munch) the cookies. She ____4____ (be) very irritated as the thief was busy in ____5____ (diminish) her stock. With each cookie she took, the man took another. When the last cookie was left, the man ____6____ (take) it smartly, broke it in half. The woman ____7____ (offer) one half of the cookie by the man. The angry woman got up from there

and tried to gather her belongings. Soon she gasped with surprise to see her packed box of cookies inside one of her bags. The embarrassed woman ____8____(understand) that the man was kind enough to share his box of cookies with her.

Question 6

Do as directed:

[6]

- i) The lady said to me, “Your parcel arrived yesterday.” (Change into Indirect speech.)
- ii) The boy was young. The boy wore thick spectacles. (Join without using *and*, *but* or *so*)
- iii) A small crowd had gathered near the collapsed bridge. (Identify the Figure of speech in the given sentence.)
- iv) I completed my homework..... (at my desk, before the power cut, quickly) (Rewrite the sentence using the words and phrases in brackets and put them in the correct position.)
- v) Add some milk to the coffee. (Change into Passive voice)
- vi) He tried to _____the watch as a genuine Rolex. (Fill in the blank with an appropriate phrasal verb)